Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, April 15, 2024

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

Point of Personal Privilege

Councillor Henry raised a point of personal privilege noting that she has requested accessible accommodations with respect to section 11.7 of the Council Procedure By-law 'no Member shall speak to the same questions for longer than five minutes'. Mayor Collier ruled the point of personal privilege out of order.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on March 25, 2024 be adopted.
CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Community Living Month Shine a Light Campaign

Crystal Greig, Self-Advocate, Community Living Ajax, Pickering & Whitby, delivered a presentation regarding the Community Living Month Shine a Light Campaign.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. Siobhan Pearce, Employment Specialist, Community Living Ajax, Pickering & Whitby and Shannon Goddard, Team Lead of Community Participation Program, Community Living Ajax, Pickering & Whitby, responded to questions from Council Members.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked S. Pearce, S. Goddard and C. Greig for their delegation.

5.2 Proclamation: Youth Week 2024

Ashley McWhirter, Community Recreation Coordinator and Tyshawn Hoffstead, Program Supervisor–Youth Hubs, delivered a presentation regarding Youth Week 2024.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. A. McWhirter and T. Hoffstead, responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier presented the proclamation certificate and proclaimed May 1-7, 2024 as Youth Week in the Town of Ajax.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked A. McWhirter and T. Hoffstead for their presentation.

5.3 **Presentation: 2023 Grants and Partnerships Update**

This item has been deferred to a future Council meeting.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence items 6.5 and 6.14 for discussion.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.6, 6.7, 6.8, 6.9, 6.10, 6.11, 6.12, 6.13, 6.15, 6.16, 6.17 and 6.18) dated April 15, 2024 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.5

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Item 6.5 (“Town of Whitby – Removal of Tolls from Highway 407”) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

Item 6.14

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That Item 6.9 (“Township of Alnwick/Haldimand – Highway Traffic Act Amendments, Automated Speed Enforcement Systems”) of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1. **Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report**

None

7.2. **General Government Committee Report**

7.2.1 **General Government Committee, April 8, 2024**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated April 8, 2024 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 **Summary of Advisory Committee Activities**

Moved by: S. Lee

Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities Report dated April 15, 2024, as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

None

8. Regional Councillors' Report

8.1 Regional Councillor's Report – M. Crawford – April 15, 2024

Regional Councillor Crawford provided updates from the Region related to an automated cart-based garbage collection pilot project, the Harwood Avenue Water Pumping Station and transit. Council Members asked questions related to the contents of the report. Regional Councillor Crawford responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the report titled ' Regional Councillor's Report - M. Crawford - April 15, 2024' be received for information.

CARRIED

8.2 Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to Bill 185, Cutting Red Tape to Build More Homes Act, 2024 and immunization programs and services. Council Members asked questions related to the reports. Regional Councillor Lee and Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of April 15, 2024 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Renewed Call to Recognize and Combat the Intimate Partner Violence Epidemic

Regional Councillor Crawford and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS Intimate partner violence (IPV) is physical, sexual and emotional abuse and aggression that occurs in an intimate relationship;

AND WHEREAS in 2019, of the 107,810 people who reported Intimate Partner Violence to police, 79% were women;

AND WHEREAS on March 14th, 2018, Krassimira Pejcinovski and her children, 15-year-old Roy and 13-year-old Venellia, were murdered by Krassimira's boyfriend in an act of Intimate Partner Violence;

AND WHEREAS on March 30th, 2024, Jennifer Polak of Ajax was allegedly murdered by her boyfriend in an act of Intimate Partner Violence;

AND WHEREAS between 2014 and 2019, despite accounting for about 5% of all women in Canada, Indigenous women accounted for 21% of all women murdered by an intimate

partner;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax passed a motion on April 17th, 2023, calling on the Ontario Government and Region of Durham to declare an Intimate Partner Violence epidemic, per recommendation #1 of the Renfrew County Inquest; and

AND WHEREAS the Legislature of the Province of Ontario is currently considering *Bill 173, Intimate Partner Violence Epidemic Act, 2024* which, if enacted, would recognize Intimate Partner Violence as an epidemic;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

THAT the Town of Ajax renew its call to the Province of Ontario to recognize Intimate Partner Violence as an epidemic through the passage of *Bill 173, Intimate Partner Violence Epidemic Act, 2024*;

AND THAT Town of Ajax staff be directed to facilitate a roundtable discussion with subject matter experts and local service providers for survivors of IPV to provide guidance on actions the Town can take to combat Intimate Partner Violence in Ajax;

AND THAT this motion be distributed to Ajax MPP Patrice Barnes, the Ministry of the Attorney General, the Ministry of Women's Social and Economic Opportunity, the Region of Durham and Durham municipalities, Renfrew County, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario, Luke's Place Herizon House and Violence Prevention Coordinating Council of Durham (VPCC).

CARRIED

9.2 **Increasing the Number of Judges in Ontario and Canada**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS judges are appointed exclusively by the Federal and Provincial governments;

AND WHEREAS R. v. Jordan, 2016 established the need for a new framework for applying s.11(b) of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms, which states that "Any person charged with an offence has the right to be tried within a reasonable time";

AND WHEREAS there currently exists a deficit of judges in the Province of Ontario and in the Region of Durham;

AND WHEREAS a deficit of judges denies the public access to justice and results in cases being thrown out without being tried, including tens of thousands of traffic cases in Durham Region alone;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED:

1. **THAT** The Town of Ajax calls on the Federal and Provincial governments to fulfil their responsibilities to appoint enough judges and justices of the peace to provide timely and complete access to justice;

2. **AND THAT** a copy of this motion be provided to The Prime Minister of Canada, The Premier of Ontario, The Minister of Justice and Attorney General of Canada, The Attorney General of Ontario, Members of Provincial Parliament representing the Region of Durham, Members of Parliament representing the Region of Durham, The Region of Durham, Lower-tier municipalities in Durham Region and the Association of Municipalities of Ontario.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 18-2024 and By-law numbers 27-2024 to 28-2024 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Members requested that the question be divided and that By-law 18-2024 be voted on separately.

Motion 1

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law numbers 27-2024 to 28-2024 be read a first, second and third time and passed.
CARRIED

Motion 2

Members of Council asked questions regarding By-law 18-2024. Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer and Jaclyn Grossi, Town Clerk, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law number 18-2024 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Amendment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Section 10.5 of draft By-law number 18-2024 be amended by striking “$1,000.00” and replacing with $500.00”.
CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law number 18-2024, as amended, be read a first, second, third time and passed.
CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That By-law number 29-2024 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its meeting held on April 15, 2024, be read a first, second and third time and passed.
CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the April 15, 2024 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (2:39 p.m.)
CARRIED

_____
Mayor

_____
D-Clerk